

Ubuntu Live Server + Fail2Ban Setup

This is a simple step-by-step of how I set up an **Ubuntu Live Server** and configured **Fail2Ban** to secure SSH. Writing it down so I (or anyone) can reproduce it.

What I did

1. Updated the server

```
sudo apt update && sudo apt upgrade -y
```

1. Installed Fail2Ban and UFW

```
sudo apt install fail2ban ufw -y
```

1. Enabled the firewall (UFW)

```
sudo ufw default deny incoming  
sudo ufw default allow outgoing  
sudo ufw allow OpenSSH  
sudo ufw enable
```

1. Copied the default fail2ban config

```
sudo cp /etc/fail2ban/jail.conf /etc/fail2ban/jail.local
```

1. Edited jail.local for SSH protection

Opened it with nano:

```
sudo nano /etc/fail2ban/jail.local
```

And changed the sshd section:

```
[sshd]
enabled = true
port    = ssh
filter  = sshd
logpath = /var/log/auth.log
maxretry = 5
bantime = 600
findtime = 600
```

1. Restarted Fail2Ban

```
sudo systemctl enable fail2ban
sudo systemctl restart fail2ban
```

1. Checked status

```
sudo fail2ban-client status sshd
```

1. Tested it

Tried wrong SSH passwords a few times from another machine, then checked if my IP was banned with:

```
sudo fail2ban-client status sshd
```

Notes

- If you're using a Live USB without persistence, changes won't survive reboot unless you install Ubuntu to disk or enable persistence.
- You can unban yourself if locked out:

```
sudo fail2ban-client set sshd unbanip YOUR.IP.HERE
```

- Logs are here:

```
sudo tail -f /var/log/fail2ban.log
```

That's it.